To find out the head count of people falling in various level of consumption the Monthly Per Capita Expenditure (MPCE) is calculated from Household consumption expenditure. It is arrived at by dividing the household monthly consumer expenditure by household size.

MPCE = Household monthly consumer expenditure / Household size

To collect the consumption expenditure data, the respondents are requested to recall and report the volume of consumption during a particular period say a week or month. This period is called **Reference period** or **Recall period**.

The respondents were requested to recall their consumption of the following three groups of items:

1. food, *pan* (betel leaves), tobacco, intoxicants and fuel &light
2. clothing and footwear and
3. Miscellaneous goods and services and durable articles.

The Report No 555 summarised MPCEs based on different recall periods in page 9 is as follows:

> *"2.3.4* **Uniform Reference Period MPCE** *(or* **MPCE$_{URP}$***): Household consumer expenditure on each item is recorded for a reference period of "***last 30 days***" (preceding the date of survey).*
>
> *2.3.5* **Mixed Reference Period MPCE** *(or* **MPCE$_{MRP}$***): Household consumer expenditure on items of clothing and bedding, footwear, education, institutional medical care, and durable goods is recorded for a reference period of "***last 365 days***", and expenditure on all other items is recorded with a reference period of "***last 30 days***".*
>
> *2.3.6* **Modified Mixed Reference Period MPCE** *(or* **MPCE$_{MMRP}$***): household consumer expenditure on edible oil, egg, fish and meat, vegetables, fruits, spices, beverages, refreshments, processed food, pan, tobacco and intoxicants is recorded for a reference period of "***last seven**